```
class DataEmitter
  constructor: (interval) ->
    @listeners = []
    setInterval ->
      listener() for listener in listeners
    , interval
  ondata: (listener) ->
    listeners.push listener

emitter = new DataEmitter 1.5*ONE_SECOND

emitter.ondata ->
  console.log "Service responds at #{difference()} seconds past minute"
```

A fake DataEmitter class for emitting events on a schedule

This event emitter is a fake, but it helps to show what an event emitter does. In Node.js there's an `EventEmitter` class in the core `events` module.

9.3.3. Using event emitters in Node.js

The `EventEmitter` in the core Node.js `events` module is a JavaScript class that you can extend in your own CoffeeScript program:

```
{EventEmitter} = require 'events'

class CompetitorEmitter extends EventEmitter
```

If the `CompetitorEmitter` is going to emit competitors as it reads them, then it doesn't make sense for it to load the entire competitors source file in one go. Instead, it should open the source file as a stream using `createReadStream` from the Node.js core `fs` module:

```
fs = require 'fs'

sourceStream = fs.createReadStream 'competitors.txt'
```

The `createReadStream` method returns a `Stream`, which `extends` `EventEmitter`. It allows a file to be read in chunks instead of waiting to load the whole file.

The following listing contains a `CompetitorsEmitter` that reads the competitors file and emits arrays of competitors while the file is being read.